



JUDGMENT — PROBLEM OWNERSHIP

DOCTRINE

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Judgment Officers are human case owners and roving intellectual commissions, not analysts at the end of a queue. A working portfolio is approximately five live problems: four directed and one mandatory, bounded self-directed curiosity problem. The officer states why it matters and closes/hands it off before opening another.

Each consequential problem has a short commission stating the question without implying the answer. Within legal/security boundaries the JO may speak directly across Sable Harbor, attend ordinary operations, visit sites, sit with collectors, ride with JAG, engage technical/external experts, request records or collection through Contact, hold Open Problem Hours, and protect sensitive sources. The JO has no line command: power compels institutional attention to a question, not operational action.

The living **Problem Book** answers: What am I trying to understand? What do I believe and why? What does not make sense? What next? What would change my mind? “Things that do not make sense” remains explicit. JAG handoff and problem transfer require conversation/read-back, not ticket reassignment.

At the Judgment Table, other officers professionally attack a consequential judgment. It is not a vote; the originator remains responsible and dissents travel. Closure may be resolved, superseded, merged, unresolvable with available evidence, or premise invalid without excessive bureaucracy.

Judgment Watch is a small Judgment function physically/operationally at Contact intake. It preserves raw signals, correlates weak signals, routes material, and proposes new problems but never owns the resulting problem.

A private longitudinal self-knowledge record supports calibration and blind-spot learning, not gamified ranking or punishment. Volume and throughput are poor primary measures; management asks whether the officer is getting closer to truth.

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